

Name: _____

Date: _____

The Muddy Footprints

Year 4 reading comprehension · Story · 11 marks · About 20 minutes

When Nadia came home from school, the kitchen smelled wonderfully of fresh bread. Dad had baked a loaf that morning and left it to cool on the low windowsill. Now the windowsill was empty.

“Who has taken the bread?” Nadia whispered. She was determined to find out.

First, she knelt on the floor and studied the tiles. A line of muddy prints led from the back door to the window. They were small and round, with four toes and tiny claw marks. Nadia frowned. They were definitely not made by boots.

Next, she noticed a trail of crumbs across the floor and out through the open back door. She followed it into the garden, stepping carefully past the flower beds. The crumbs led all the way to the wooden bench under the apple tree.

Nadia crouched down and peered underneath. There, caught on a splinter of wood, was a tuft of ginger fur. From the shadows came a soft, contented sigh, followed by the thump of a tail and the sound of loud, happy chewing.

Nadia shook her head. “Biscuit,” she said, “you are in big trouble.” A damp black nose poked out into the light, and a pair of guilty brown eyes looked up at her. A few crumbs still clung to his whiskers.

1. Where had Dad left the bread to cool? (1 mark)

2. What was the first clue Nadia found? (1 mark)

3. How do you know the prints were not made by someone wearing boots? Give two details from the story. (2 marks)

4. Find and copy one word that shows Nadia was serious about solving the mystery. (1 mark)

5. What did Nadia find under the bench? (1 mark)

6. The writer describes Biscuit's eyes as "guilty". Why? (2 marks)

7. What kind of animal do you think Biscuit is? Give two pieces of evidence. (2 marks)

8. Choose the sentence that best sums up the story. Write its letter. (1 mark)

- A. Nadia and her dad bake a fresh loaf of bread together after school.
- B. Nadia follows clues and finds out that Biscuit took the bread.
- C. Nadia chases a thief out of the garden and then tells the police.

Answer: _____

Writing task: Write a short mystery story. Something goes missing, and a clue leads to the answer.
